

Do Self-Reported Language and Reading Skills Predict Performance on Remote Behavioral Tasks in Adults?

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Remote Adult Language Experiment (ReAL-E)

Goal: Develop an unsupervised remote language assessment tool to identify adults with communication disorders



Why do we need unsupervised remote language testing?

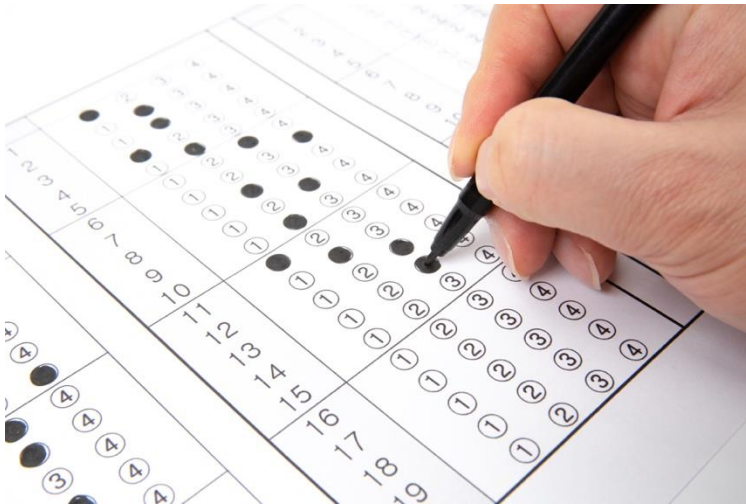
Research

- Decreases time investment and reduces staffing needs
- Increases sample diversity
- Enables large-scale genetics research

Clinical

- Opens new routes for clinical screening and identification
- Expands geographical access to patients
- Creates flexible scheduling

Self-report questionnaires vs. behavioral tasks



Purpose

- To examine whether self-reported language and reading skills predicts performance on remotely administered behavioral tasks.



Remote Adult
Language Experiment

Methods

Participants

- N = 162
 - 60 Male, 102 Female
 - 114 English Monolingual, 48 Spanish-English Bilingual
 - Mean age: 38.36 (SD=10.83; Range=19-64 years)
- Completed study at home on their personal computers

Self-Report Questionnaire

- Expressive language questions:
 1. Do people correct your writing because of grammatical errors?
 2. Do you have a hard time figuring out what you want to say or how to say it?
 3. Would you describe yourself as a poor speller?
- Sum score of responses:
 - Likert scale (0 = Rarely to 3 = Very Often)
 - Yes/No (0 = No; 1 = Yes)

Behavioral Tasks

Speech

1. Diadochokinetic rates*
2. Nonword repetition
3. Multisyllabic word repetition

*not examined

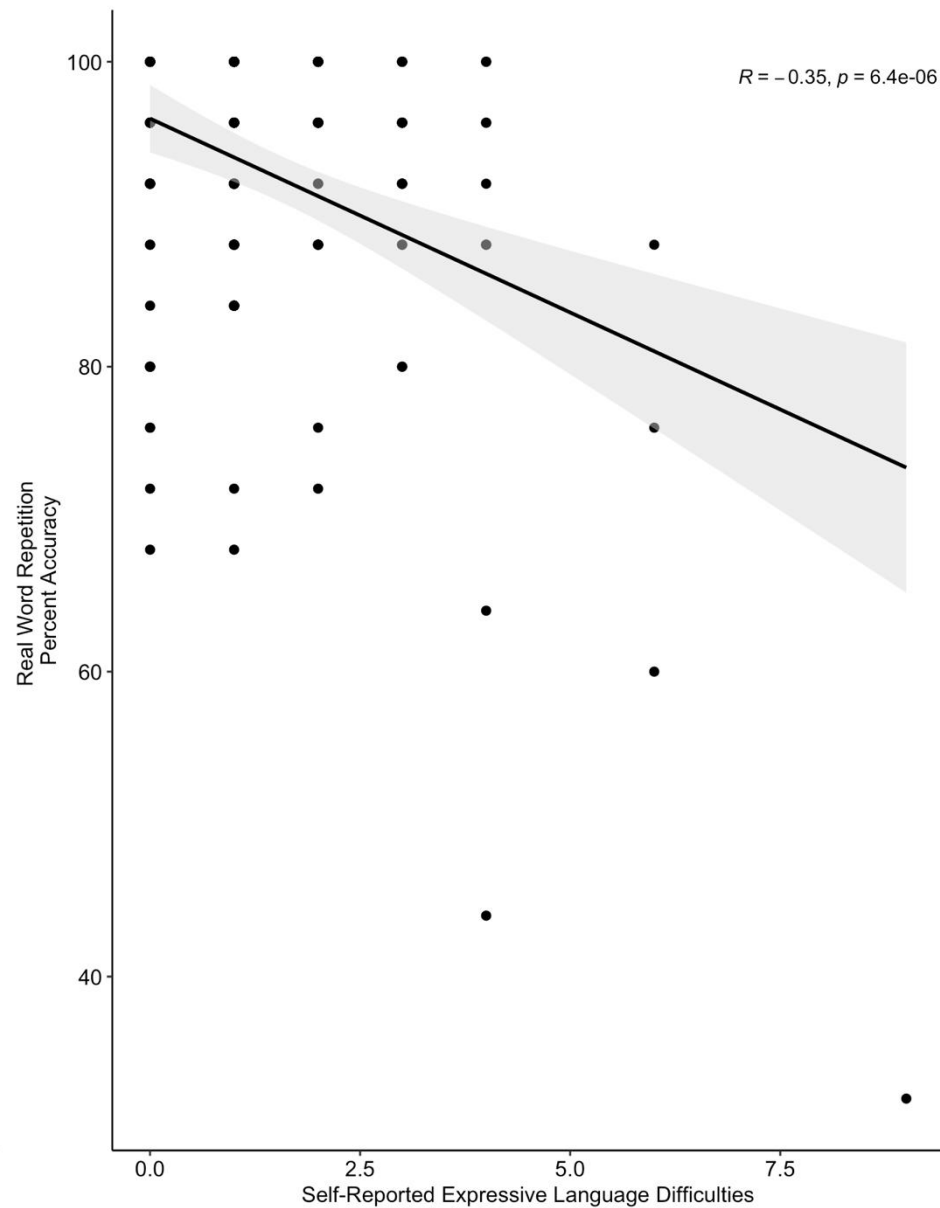
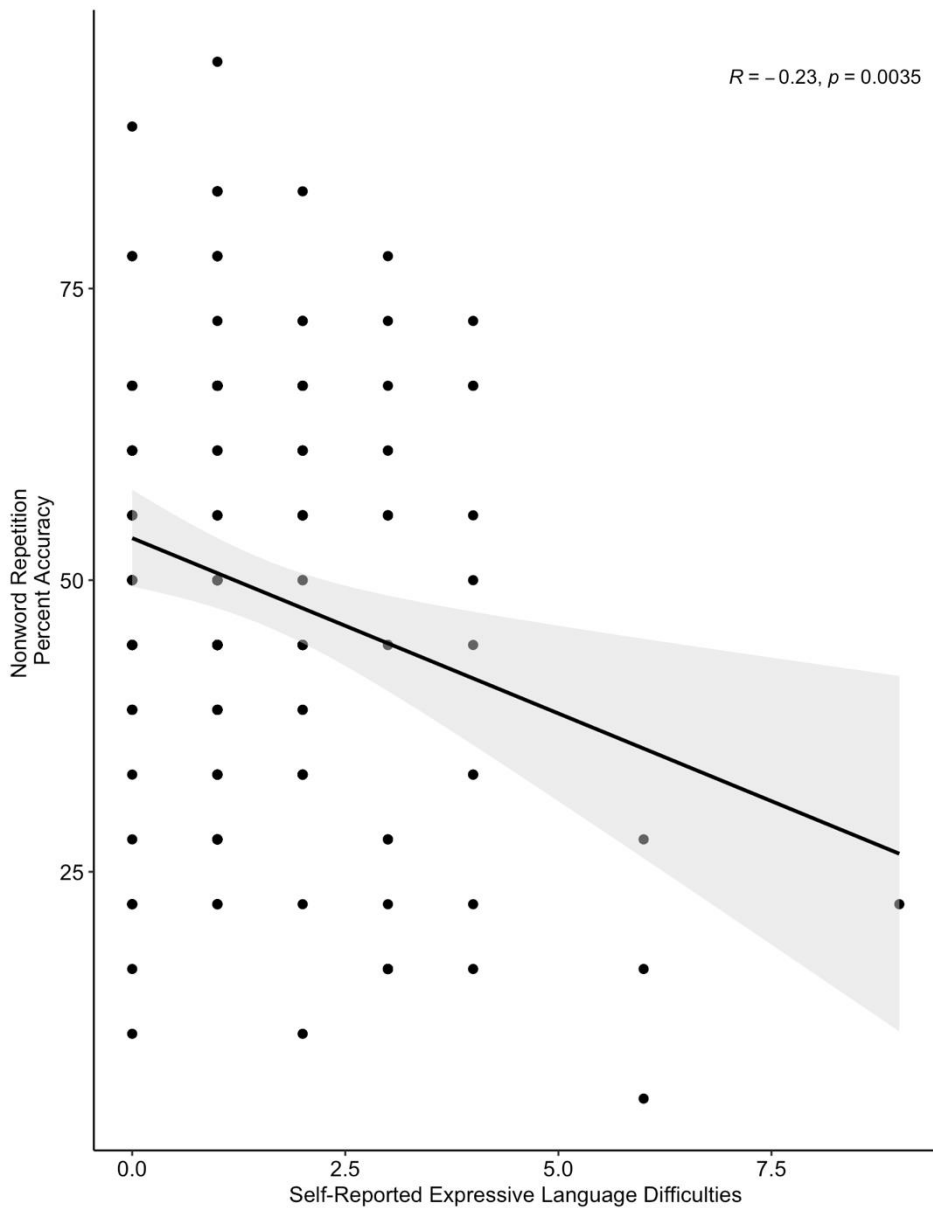
Language

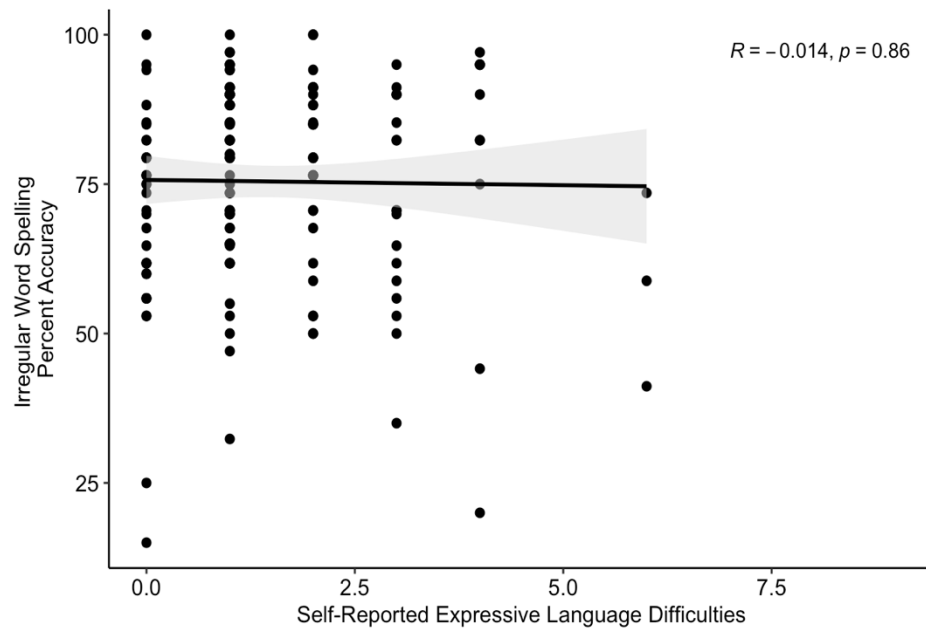
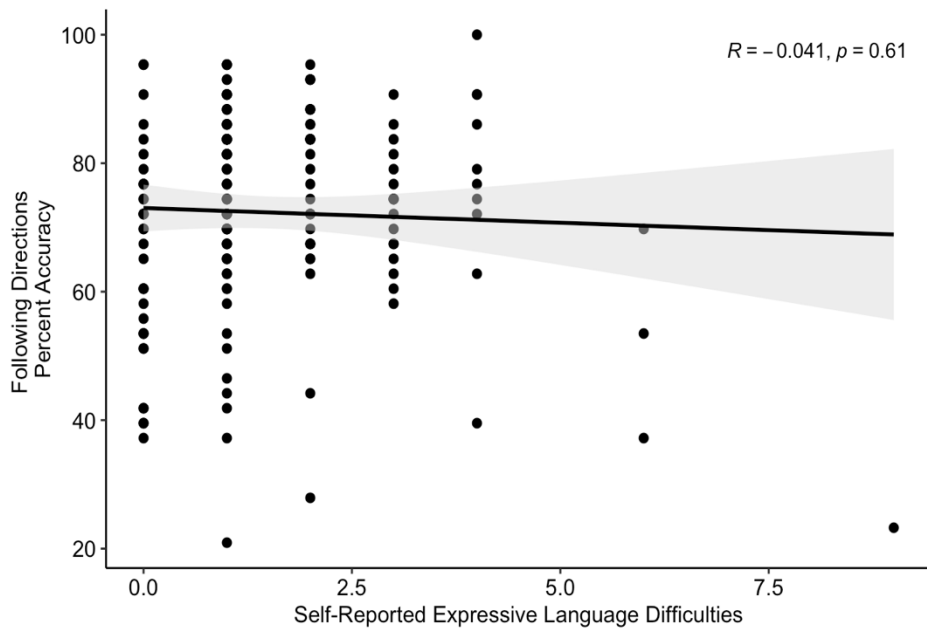
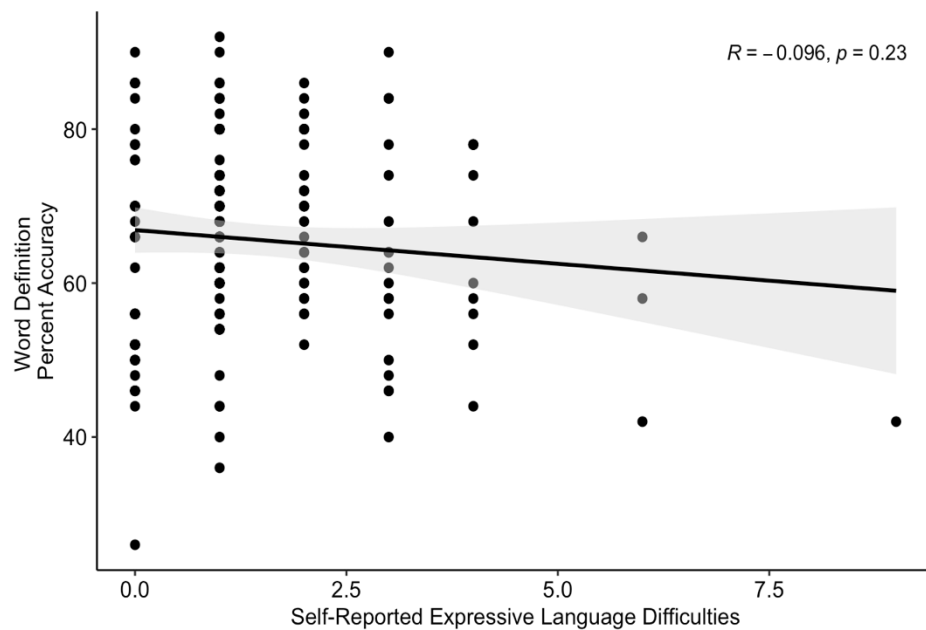
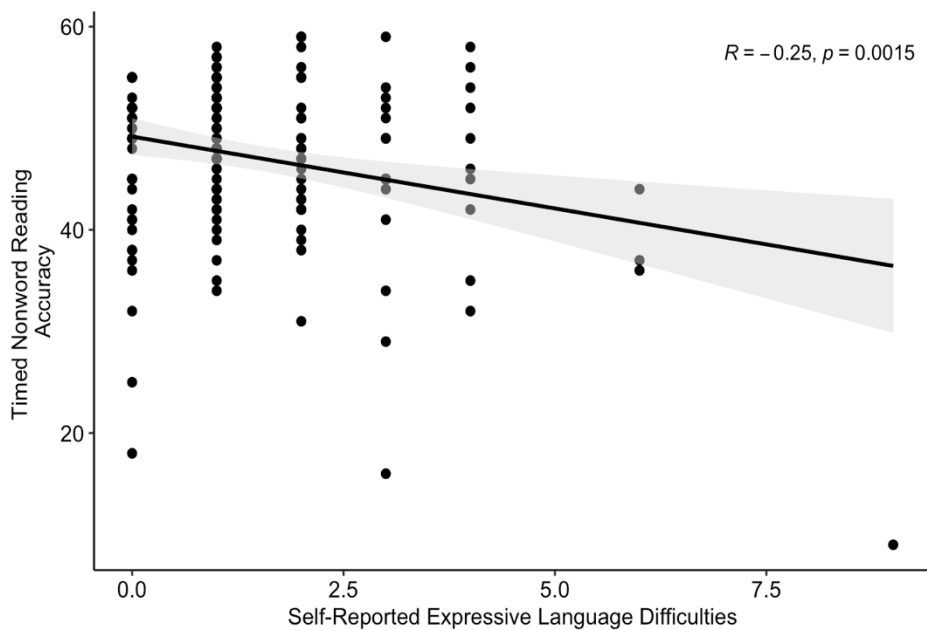
4. Nonword reading
5. Word definition
6. Following directions
7. Irregular word spelling

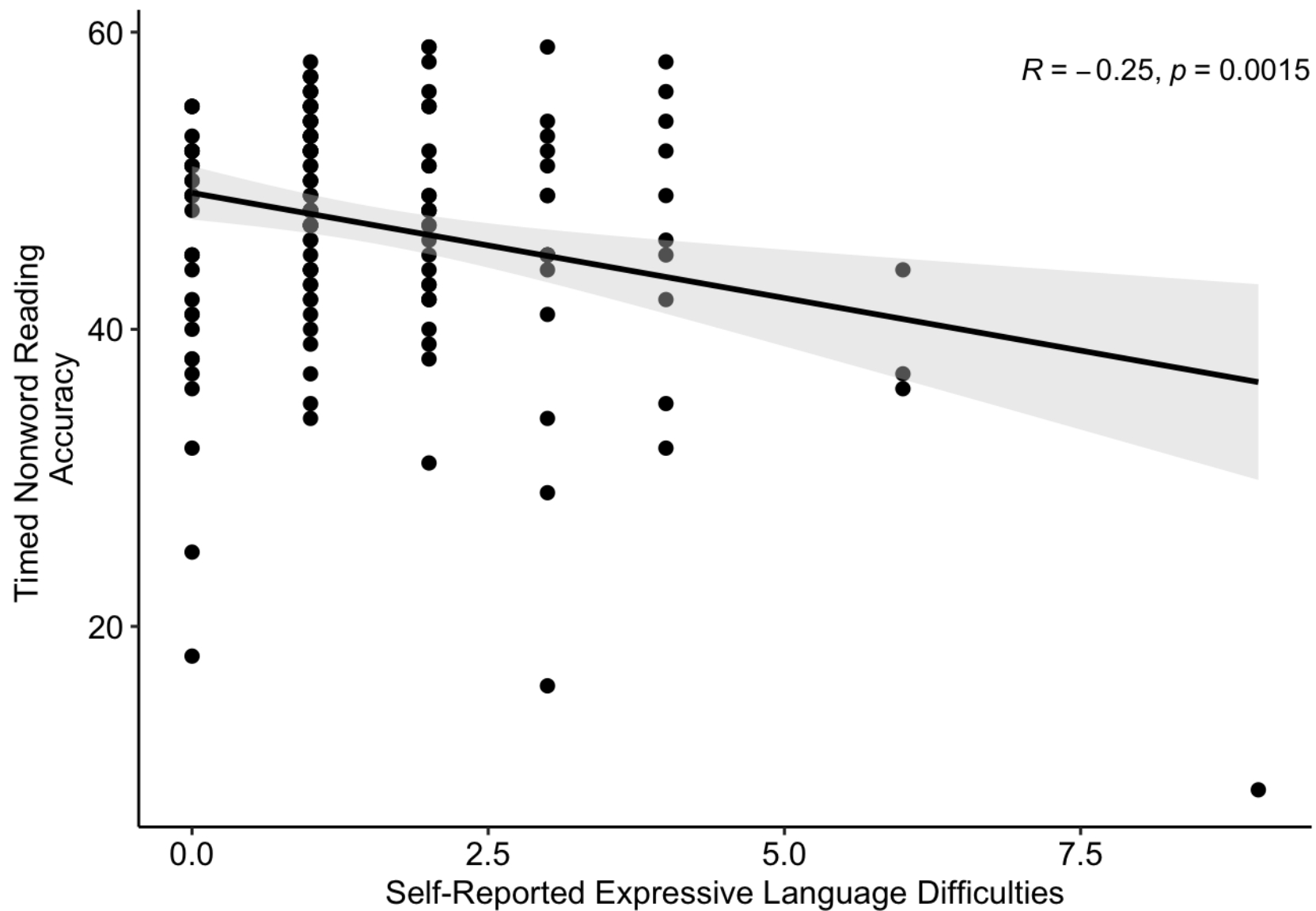
Analysis

- Linear Regressions:
 - Outcomes: Percent accuracy on each behavioral task
 - Predictor of interest: Self-report expressive language sum score
 - Control variables: Age, language status

Results







Discussion

Conclusion

- Results show that our self-report expressive language questions predict performance on ***three*** remote behavioral tasks.
- Many adults who reported no problems also scored low on these behavioral tasks, indicating a need for refining our questions.



Thank you!